Southern Cross Pilgrimage

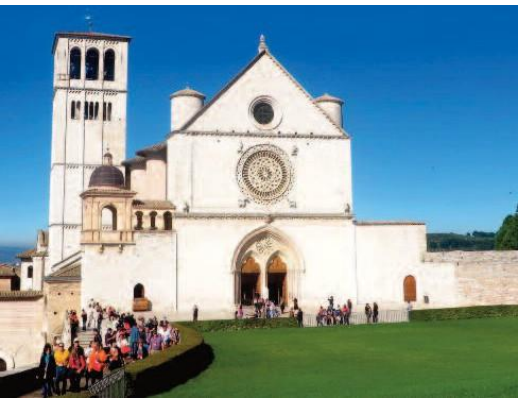
MEDJUGORJE • ROME
ASSISI • LORETO



12 to 21 October 2026
Led by Bishop Noel Rucastle

Pray in **Medjugorje** and visit **Rome**, with papal audience, and see **Assisi**, the town of St Francis, and **Loreto** with Mary's House. Plus **Dubrovnik**

THREE COUNTRIES IN ONE TOUR!







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St Peter's Basilica in the Vatican



Pope Leo XIV at a General Audience



The Colosseum



Porziuncola in the St Mary of the Angels basilica



Basilica of St Francis in Assisi

Monday, October 12

We depart from OR Tambo International in Johannesburg to catch our flight and begin our pilgrimage to Medjugorje, Rome, Assisi and Loreto with **Bishop Noel Rucastle of Oudtshoorn**.

Tuesday, October 13

We arrive in **Rome**, and visit the **Basilica of St Paul Outside the Walls** with the authenticated tomb of St Paul the Apostle, and the images of every pope in history, represented in medallion mosaics. We then explore the **Rome of the Renaissance**, including the **Trevi Fountain**, **Navona Square** as well as the **Pantheon**. Overnight: Rome

Wednesday, October 14

Today we see the pope at the **general audience** in **St Peter's Square**. It is an unforgettable experience to see Pope Leo XIV close-up (subject to the pope being in Rome at the time). We visit **St Peter's Basilica**, which was built on the site where St Peter was martyred.

At **St Mary Major Basilica** we see the tomb of Pope Francis, the statue of Mary Salus Populi Romani, and the relic of the Holy Crib. **St John Lateran Basilica** is the official cathedral of Rome and of the pope. It includes many great artworks as well as a remnant said to be of the table of the Last Supper, as well as the tomb of Pope Leo XIII, who inspired our new Holy Father's choice of papal name.

We have the opportunity to see and ascend the **Holy Stairs**, said to be the staircase Jesus climbed for his trial by Pontius Pilate in Jerusalem. We also have opportunity to see the **Colosseum** and the **Roman Forum**. Overnight: Rome

Thursday, October 15

After breakfast, we leave Rome and drive through Italy's beautiful countryside to **Assisi**, the town of St Francis and his companion St Clare. The 13th-century **Basilica of St Francis** contains the sacred tomb of Francis and Giotto's beautiful frescoes of his life. The Basilica of St Clare, also from the 13th century, houses the relics of St Clare, original robes that belonged to her, as well as the miraculous crucifix that spoke to Francis.

At **San Damiano Convent** St Francis first received his miraculous calling in 1205 and St Clare died there in 1253, it is an important stop on the pilgrimage to the Franciscan holy city. It was here that St Clare repelled the invaders by holding up the monstrance.

We then visit the **Basilica di Santa Maria degli Angeli** (St Mary of the Angels), just outside Assisi. This is the place where St Francis' great mission really began and where he died. Inside the grand Baroque basilica is the **Porziuncola**, the tiny church in the meadows which St Francis was called to renovate Overnight: Assisi

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Friday, October 16

After breakfast, we leave Assisi and drive across Italy to the town of **Loreto** where we see the **Holy House of Nazareth** and the beautiful **Madonna of Loreto** which more than 50 popes have visited. Legend says that the house was transported to Italy by angels; history says it was brought over by a family called DiAngeli.

We then proceed to Ancona where we take the overnight **ferry across the Adriatic** to Split, Croatia. Overnight: Cabin on the ferry



The Sanctuary of the Holy House of Loreto

Saturday, October 17

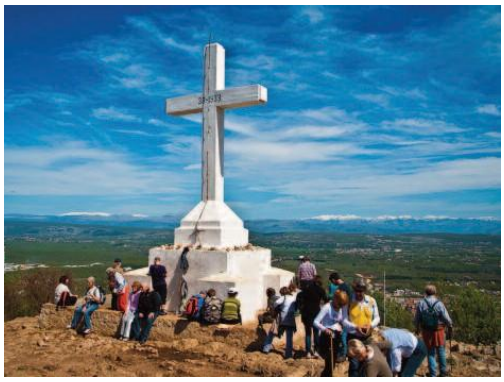
We arrive in Split in the morning, and proceed to **Medjugorje** in Bosnia-Herzegovina. We begin our time at this Marian shrine by fixing our eyes on the Lord Jesus as we follow the **Stations of the Cross** in the beautiful gardens. We also see the huge **statue of Jesus** at the moment of the resurrection, from which drops of liquid inexplicably flow. In the evening we may participate individually in the public prayers of the Rosary, Blessings of Objects, and Prayer for health of soul and body (as we can the next two evenings). Overnight: Medjugorje



St James church in MedjugorjeSplit in Croatia

Sunday, October 18

Today we have a guided tour of **Medjugorje**. If possible, there will be an encounter with one of the visionaries. There will be time for prayer, silent adoration and, if requested, confession. We also walk up **Mount Krisevac** (optional). The massive cross on the peak was erected long before the apparitions, in 1934 to mark the 1,900th anniversary of the Death and Resurrection of Jesus. Overnight: Medjugorje



Cross on Mount Krisevac

Monday, October 19

In the morning we climb the **Hill of the Apparitions** where bronze plaques depict the Mysteries of the Rosary help us meditate on the life of Our Lord. On top is the site of the first apparitions of the Virgin, a place of contemplation.

We then take the short drive to the picturesque city of **Mostar**, with its famous bridge and streets that merge Christian and Muslim cultures. Just outside the Old City, we visit the church of St Peter and Paul, which has a close relationship with Our Lady of Medjugorje.



Stari Most bridge in Mostar

Tuesday, October 20

After breakfast, we drive to **Dubrovnik**, on Croatia's Adriatic coast. Subject to our flight schedule, we will have a guided tour city of this city of history and beauty before we begin our journey home.



Cathedral of the Assumption in Dubrovnik

Wednesday, October 21

We arrive in Johannesburg in the morning, spiritually raised by our holy journey which brought us in contact with Our Lord, Our Lady and many great saints in Medjugorje, Rome and Assisi.

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ABOUT MEDJUGORJE

Since 1981, in the small village of Medjugorje, the Blessed Virgin Mary has been appearing and giving messages to the world. She tells us: "I have come to tell the world that God exists. He is the fullness of life, and to enjoy this fullness and peace, you must return to God."

On 24 June 1981, on the Podbrdo hill, six children saw a beautiful young woman carrying a little child in her arms. They were frightened at what they saw and did not come closer, even though the woman beckoned them. They knew that this woman was Our Lady.

The following day, the children returned to the same place in hope of seeing her again. With the flash of a light, the six children looked up and saw Our Lady, this time without the child. When they reached Her, they fell to their knees and began to pray with Our Lady. Before Our Lady left the children, she said: "God be with you my angels!"

There have been only five days where no apparitions were recorded. Medjugorje has been a place of peace, hope and inspiration for many. The Word of God is alive in Medjugorje, which is known to also be a place of conversion. This is why Pope Francis has authorised official pilgrimages to the sanctuary

There is always much going on in this very prayerful, peaceful place. The Virgin appears daily during the 18:40 rosary, and the visionaries transmit her message to the rest of the world.



Statue of Our Lady in Medjugorje



Statue of Jesus coming off his cross in Medjugorje

How to book on this beautiful pilgrimage

Est. Price: BWP61,531 (sharing, ex-Jhb; subject to currency, airport tax fluctuations, calculated on 25 passengers)

Includes: All flights ex-Johannesburg (incl. airport taxes), accommodation in 3 and 4-star hotels (sharing) with breakfast and dinner, ferry from Ancona to Split (accommodation in cabin), travel insurance (up to age 69), transfers, travelling on air-conditioned luxury buses, English-speaking guides, entrance fees as per itinerary.

Excludes: Visa (Schengen for Italy, applies to all three countries), tips & hotel taxes (mandatory), lunches, personal expenses, travel to and from O.R. Tambo Airport/Jhb.

A **deposit of BW10,900** secures your place on this unforgettable pilgrimage. Send proof of payment, completed booking form and a clear copy of your passport to info@fowlertours.co.za — and your place will be secured!

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For more information, please contact Debrah +26777659930 /72686433 or thetravelhubbw@gmail.com /debrahmm@thetravelhubbw.co.bw

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